

Mario Herane DBA, M.Ed, MBA, MSF

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HIGHER EDUCATION LEADER | CONTENT & PRODUCT STRATEGY IN HIGHER EDUCATION

Program Portfolio Strategy | EdTech | Digital Transformation | Market-Driven Growth

Senior higher-education strategy and transformation leader with 16+ years advising executive teams and leading enterprise initiatives across accredited U.S. and international universities

Led multi-campus strategic planning, digital transformation, enrollment growth, program portfolio development, and revenue optimization for institutions with budgets over \$120M. Based in Atlanta, bringing cross-cultural leadership, regulatory expertise, and a track record of measurable institutional improvement.

Core competencies include:

- Enterprise Strategy & Transformation
- Enrollment & Revenue Growth
- Corporate Partnerships & Business Development
- Data Analytics & Performance Measurement
- Designed and scaled a portfolio of degree, certificate, and executive education products aligned with workforce demand
- Built stackable pathways
- Used market data and employer input to define new program offerings
- Managed lifecycle of programs: design, launch, growth, and optimization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UNIVERSIDAD MAYOR, Santiago, Chile / Atlanta, GA, USA
VP OF GLOBAL AFFAIRS AND DEVELOPMENT (2021 – Present)
VP OF MANAGEMENT & DEVELOPMENT (2016 – 2021)

Served as senior strategic advisor to the President and Board, leading enterprise transformation across finance, enrollment, IT, academic operations, and digital strategy for a multi-campus university system with a \$120M budget. Directed cross-functional initiatives to improve efficiency, scale online education, expand executive education revenue, and strengthen long-term institutional sustainability.

Selected accomplishments:

- Directed an online division serving **8,000+ undergraduate and graduate students**, leading strategy, program quality, and student success initiatives.
- Designed and launched **40+ undergraduate and 20+ graduate programs**, plus a continuing education portfolio of **60+ diplomas, 20+ certificates, and 300+ courses** generating **\$12M+ annually**.
- Built corporate partnerships across **mining, banking, government, and healthcare sectors**, creating customized training and applied learning opportunities.
- Managed a **\$6M marketing strategy**, engaging 200K+ prospects, increasing annual enrollment by **16%**, and reducing cost-per-conversion by **20%**.
- Led enterprise digital transformation including **SAP S/4HANA migration, Canvas LMS rollout, Dynamics CRM implementation, Microsoft Fabric/Purview analytics platform, A.I.** and predictive retention models.
- **Executive sponsor for an institution-wide McKinsey transformation engagement**, leading strategic initiatives across revenue growth, marketing and enrollment optimization, sales effectiveness, digitalization, and productivity improvement, delivering integrated action plans, KPI tracking, and sustained operational impact, **increasing revenue by \$4M+ and decreasing cost by \$2M+.**

UNIVERSIDAD MAYOR, Santiago, Chile
DIRECTOR OF ONLINE LEARNING (2014 – 2016)

Planned and managed long-term strategy to incorporate undergraduate and graduate online learning curriculum to align with both institutional mission and overall strategic plan, developing programs in harmony with university departments and school divisions; verified online platform training for faculty members and quality of assessment for online students using supporting metrics. Certified domestic and international accreditation and academic policy compliance. Consistently evaluated emerging trends and developments and possible application and impact to institutional systems. Led department operations, financial planning, and budget management.

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Selected accomplishments:

- Led the institution-wide selection and implementation of the **Blackboard Learning Management System**, supporting more than **23,000 students and 2,000 faculty** and enabling scalable online and blended instruction.
- Expanded participation in online and blended courses from **5% to over 20%** of total enrollment through faculty training, instructional design support, and technology integration.

INNOVA COLLEGE (now Nexus University), Miami, Florida
CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER (2008 – 2014), **CHANCELLOR** (2014 – Present)

Assessed business models and established college as a corporation, instituting business plan, market valuation, and financial support. Directed and administered university finances, planning, capital budgets, vendor management, taxes, human resources, recruiting, hiring and payroll management. Spearheaded business growth and development, securing strategic alliances, investments, and funding. Served as key liaison with faculty, staff, parents, and students. Developed and oversaw administration of recruitment programs to increase student referrals and enrolment.

Selected accomplishments:

- Increased enrollment by **400%** through strategic partnerships, international alliances, and targeted recruitment initiatives.
- Brought an **entrepreneurial mindset** to Nexus University's development, driving program innovation, partnerships, and market expansion that enabled rapid growth and long-term sustainability.
- **Directed U.S. based operations in Florida**, managing licensing with the **Florida Commission for Independent Education** and leading **MSCHE accreditation processes**; continue to serve as MSCHE peer evaluator and visit chair across multiple U.S. institutions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

GEORGIA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY – Atlanta, GA, 2025 - In Progress
Master of Science in Analytics

UNIVERSITY of LIVERPOOL — Liverpool, UK, 2021
Doctor in Business Administration

AMERICAN COLLEGE OF EDUCATION — Indianapolis, IN, 2021
Master of Education in Higher Education

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA — Gainesville, FL, 2013
Master of Business Administration

FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY— Miami, FL, 2010
Master of Science in Finance

UNIVERSIDAD DIEGO PORTALES — Santiago, Chile, 2007
Bachelor of Science in Civil Industrial Engineering

Professional Development

Professional Certificate in Leadership Excellence, 2024 - Certified Higher Education Professional (CHEP)
Professional Certificate on Innovation and Entrepreneurship, 2023 – Universidad de Salamanca
Public Narrative: Leadership, Storytelling, and Action, 2022 – Harvard Kennedy School
Crisis Leadership in Higher Education, 2021 – Harvard Kennedy School
Digital Transformation, 2018 – Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Leading Digital Transformation and Innovation, 2017 – Stanford University & Hasso Plattner Institute
Strategic Management and Black Belt for Six Sigma, 2008 – Universidad Mayor

Affiliations

Hispanic Association of Colleges and Universities (HACU) Fellow – Academy of Leadership
Peer Reviewer and Visit Chair – Middle States Commissioner for Higher Education (MSCHE)
J-Well Affiliate – Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)
Active Member – Global Design Thinking Alliance (GDTA)
Active Member - Anthology Community Leadership Circle (CLC)